

University of Arkansas

Fall 2026

Day One Setup Guide

Updated August 16, 2026

This guide will assist you in preparing you for the remainder of the semester. Use your uark.edu email address for every account you create here: the JetBrains verification depends on it, and it keeps your coursework accounts separate from anything personal.

The screens pictured in this guide are drawn to show the layout and the labels you are looking for. Vendors redesign their pages often, so if the page in front of you looks a little different, find the same labels rather than the same colors.

What you will do

Part	What you are doing	What you turn in
1. Course Slack	Joining the workspace where we answer questions	Nothing — arrive with it joined
2. zyBooks	Subscribing to the course textbook	Nothing — arrive with it subscribed
3. GitHub account	Creating a free account for code and assignments	Your username, through the Microsoft Form
4. GitHub Student Developer Pack	Applying for free student access to developer tools	Nothing — but apply on day one, it is the slow one
5. GitHub Desktop	Installing the app that syncs your work to GitHub	Nothing — arrive with it installed
6. Liberica JDK 25 (Full)	Installing the Java compiler and runtime	Nothing — arrive with it installed
7. JetBrains Student Pack	Claiming your free student license	Nothing — arrive with it approved
8. IntelliJ IDEA	Installing the editor we use all semester	Nothing — arrive with it activated

Part 1. Join the course Slack workspace

1. Open the workspace invite in a browser:
https://join.slack.com/t/ineg-22104-fall-2026/shared_invite/zt-46xakw3hi-oAR11yLLrKXyKyDx9bS0pg
2. Enter your uark.edu email address and click Continue.
3. Slack emails you a confirmation code. Type it into the page.
4. Enter your full name.

5. Install the Slack desktop app from slack.com/downloads, or keep using Slack in your browser. The app is easier to notice.

Part 2. Subscribe to the course zyBook

zyBooks is the textbook for this course. Unlike everything else in this guide, it costs money: the subscription is \$94, you pay it once, and it lasts the semester.

If you cannot pay in the first, zyBooks will front you the access. On the subscribe page, click Have payment questions, expand the last question, and fill in the short form. You get 14 days immediately, and the work you do during those 14 days is recorded, so nothing is lost. Slack DM me if the 14 days are going to run out before your aid arrives.

6. Go to learn.zybooks.com and click Create account. Use your uark.edu address so your work lines up with the class roster.
7. Fill in your name, email address, and a password, then create the account.
8. When the zyBook code box appears, enter UARKINEG22104Fall2026 exactly as written, with no spaces. Click Continue, then View zyBook.
9. Subscribe from the zyBook home page.
10. Sign out and back in at learn.zybooks.com to confirm the zyBook now appears in your library.

Part 3. Create a GitHub account

GitHub is where you will get starter code, keep your own work backed up, and turn in projects later in the semester. The account is free and stays yours after the course ends.

Create the account

11. Go to github.com/signup in any browser.
12. The signup page shows every field at once — email, password, username, and the email preferences question — with a single button at the bottom. Enter your uark.edu email address in the first field.
13. Create a password. GitHub requires at least 15 characters, or at least 8 characters including a number and a lowercase letter.
14. Choose a username. It may contain only letters, numbers, and single hyphens. Pick something you would be comfortable showing an employer; a variation on your real name works well.
15. Answer the email preferences question (either answer is fine) and solve the verification puzzle if you are shown one.
16. Click Continue. GitHub creates the account and sends your verification code.

Verify your email

17. GitHub emails you a six-digit code, usually within a minute. If it has not arrived after a few minutes, check your Junk folder.
18. Type the code into the verification screen. If it expires before you get to it, click the link to send a new one.
19. GitHub may ask a few setup questions about your interests and plan. You can skip them, and the free plan is all you need — do not pay for anything.

Send me your username

Your username is the last part of your profile address, `github.com/your-username`, and it also appears at the top of the menu when you click your avatar in the upper-right corner. It is not your email address.

20. Open the Microsoft Form for INEG 22104 at <https://forms.cloud.microsoft/r/ZhnF2VfkiH>.
21. Enter your name and your GitHub username exactly as it appears, including hyphens and capitalization.
22. Submit the form. A confirmation screen means I have it; you do not need to Slack DM me separately.

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `https://github.com/signup → verify`. The page is divided into two main sections. The left section, titled "Verify your email address", states "We sent a launch code to you@uark.edu" and displays a six-digit code: 2 8 4 6 0 1. Below the code, it says "Code expires — request a new one if it does." and has a green "Continue" button. A red circle with the number 1 points to the code, with the text "Type the 6-digit code from your email". The right section, titled "Where to find your username", shows a text box containing `github.com/razorback-jdoe`. A red circle with the number 2 points to the text box, with the text "Copy it exactly — hyphens and case matter." Below this, it says "Or: click your avatar (top-right) → your username appears at the top of the menu." and "It is not your email address, and it is not the display name you typed during setup." At the bottom, a green box titled "Last step: submit your username" contains the text "Open the Microsoft Form link printed above, enter your GitHub username exactly as it appears, then click Submit." A small note at the bottom of the page states "Illustration of the page layout — the live site may look slightly different."

Figure 1. Verifying your email, finding your username, and what to submit.

Once the form is submitted, go straight on to Part 4. That application takes the longest to come back, so it should be in GitHub's hands today.

Part 4. Claim the GitHub Student Developer Pack

The Student Developer Pack is GitHub's bundle of free professional tools for verified students. Apply on the same day you create your account, because this is the slowest item on the list: GitHub reviews the enrollment document you upload, and while many decisions land within a day or two, some take longer. It also earns you a second way to prove student status to JetBrains in Part 7, which is useful if your uark.edu address gives you any trouble there.

Have one proof of enrollment ready before you start: a photo of your student ID showing a current enrollment date, your class schedule, your transcript, or an enrollment verification letter.

23. Add your uark.edu address to your GitHub account and verify it, under Settings and then Emails.
24. Go to github.com/settings/education/benefits and click Start an application.
25. Fill in the form: name the University of Arkansas as your school, choose Student, and upload your proof of enrollment. Photograph the whole document in good light, since an unreadable image is the most common reason an application comes back.
26. Submit the application, then watch for GitHub's decision by email. Check your Junk folder if a few days pass in silence.
27. Once you are approved, open your GitHub Education portal to see what you now have. JetBrains is one of the offers: a free subscription for students, renewed annually.

The screenshot shows the GitHub Education — student application page. The browser address bar displays <https://github.com/settings/education/benefits>. The page is divided into two main sections: 'Before you apply' and 'Application'. The 'Before you apply' section shows the email 'you@uark.edu' with a green checkmark and the text 'Verified — this must be done first.' The 'Application' section has two dropdown menus: 'School' set to 'University of Arkansas' and 'How do you use GitHub?' set to 'Student'. Below these are two buttons: 'Upload proof of enrollment' (blue) and 'Submit application' (green). To the right of the form is a 'What happens next' section with three numbered steps: 1. 'GitHub reviews the document you upload. Many decisions land within a day or two; some take longer.' 2. 'Student ID, class schedule, transcript, or enrollment letter' (indicated by a red line pointing to the 'Upload proof of enrollment' button). 3. 'Start this early — it is the slow one' (indicated by a red line pointing to the 'Submit application' button). At the bottom of the page, a small note reads: 'Illustration of the page layout — the live site may look slightly different.'

Figure 2. Verifying your school email first, then applying with a document that proves you are enrolled.

Part 5. Install GitHub Desktop

GitHub Desktop moves your work between your laptop and GitHub without making you type Git commands. It runs on Windows 10 64-bit or later and on macOS 12 or later.

28. Go to desktop.github.com. The page detects your system and offers the matching download.
29. Click Download for Windows or Download for macOS.
30. On Windows, open your Downloads folder and double-click the setup file; GitHub Desktop launches on its own when the install finishes. On macOS, double-click the downloaded zip, then drag GitHub Desktop into your Applications folder and open it from there.
31. On the welcome screen, choose Sign in to GitHub.com and sign in with the account you created in Part 3. Your browser opens to finish the sign-in and then hands you back to the app.
32. When it asks for the name and email to attach to your commits, use your real name and your uark.edu address, then click Finish.

Part 6. Install the Liberica JDK 25 (Full)

The JDK is the Java compiler and runtime — the part that turns what you write into a program that runs. We are standardizing on BellSoft's Liberica build of OpenJDK, version 25, in the Full package. The Full package matters: it includes LibericaFX, an implementation of JavaFX for building graphical applications, which the Standard package leaves out.

Before you download, know two things about your computer: whether it runs Windows or macOS, and which processor it has. On a Mac, click the Apple menu and choose About This Mac: any Apple silicon chip — the M-series — means you want the ARM download, while an Intel chip means x86. On Windows, open Settings and look at System, then About. Most Windows laptops report x64 and take the x86 download, but newer Snapdragon machines report ARM and need the ARM one.

33. Go to bell-sw.com/pages/downloads/.
34. Select the JDK 25 LTS tab. The page opens on All versions, and there is a JDK 26 tab sitting immediately to the right of the one you want — we are standardizing on 25, so check that 25 LTS is the tab that is selected.
35. Choose your operating system and then your architecture, using what you looked up above.
36. In the Package menu, choose Full JDK. This is the step students miss most often — the page opens on Standard JDK.
37. Download the installer: the MSI file on Windows, the DMG file on macOS.
38. Run the installer and accept the defaults. On macOS, if you are warned that the file was downloaded from the internet, choose Open; the download came from bell-sw.com.

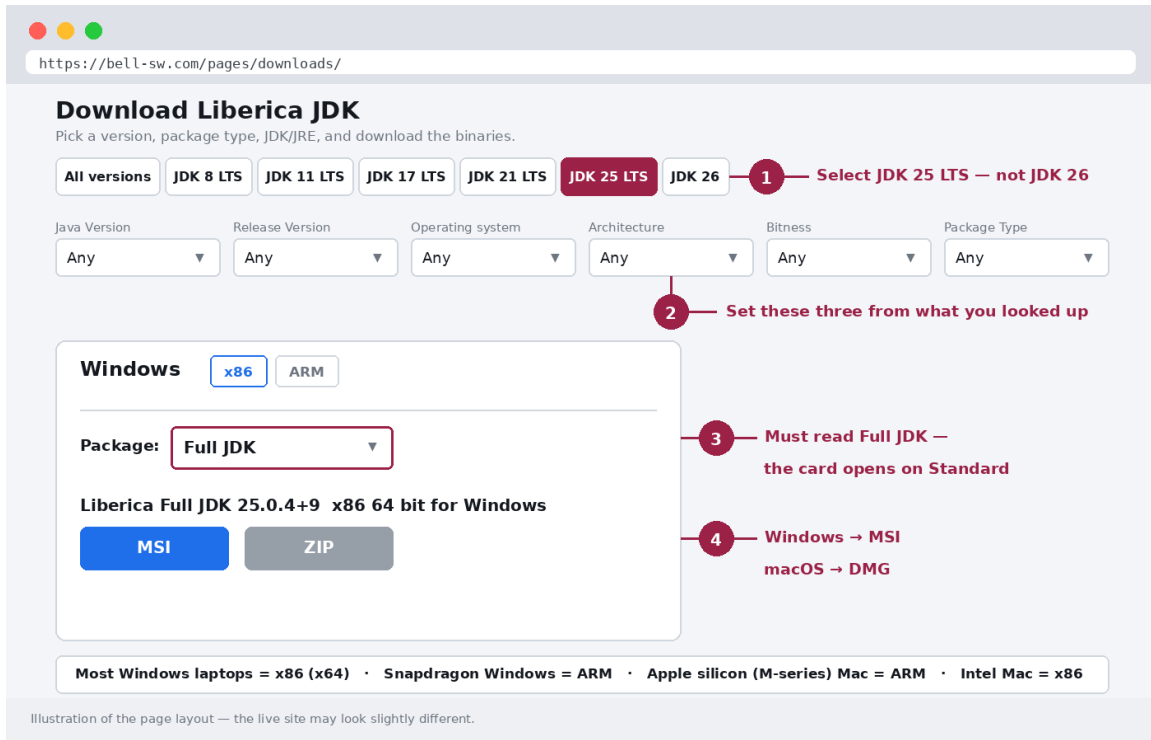


Figure 3. The settings that have to be right on the download page: version 25, your operating system, your architecture and bitness, and Full JDK.

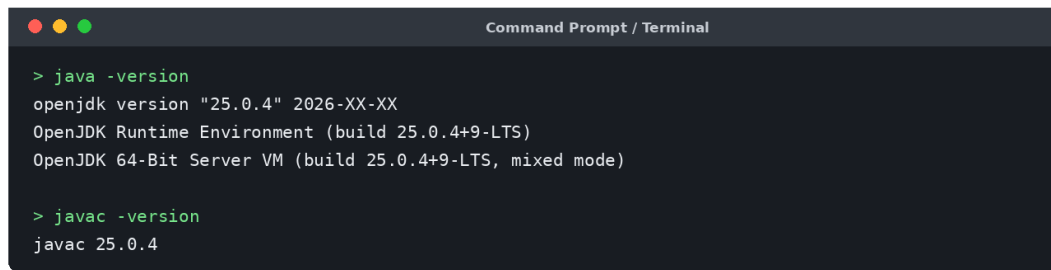
Check that it worked

Open a new command window. On Windows, press the Windows key, type cmd, and press Enter. On macOS, press Command and the space bar, type terminal, and press Enter. Type `java -version`, press Enter, then type `javac -version` and press Enter.

Both commands should answer with a version number that begins with 25. If either one reports that the command is not recognized or not found, close that window and open a brand-new one before trying again.

Check that the JDK installed correctly

Windows: open Command Prompt • macOS: open Terminal



```
> java -version
openjdk version "25.0.4" 2026-XX-XX
OpenJDK Runtime Environment (build 25.0.4+9-LTS)
OpenJDK 64-Bit Server VM (build 25.0.4+9-LTS, mixed mode)

> javac -version
javac 25.0.4
```

Looks right if:

the version number starts with 25 — and both commands answer without an error.

If you see "'java' is not recognized" or "command not found":

close the window, open a brand-new one, and try again (the PATH updates only in new windows).
Still failing? Re-run the installer and make sure the PATH / JAVA_HOME options stay checked.

Figure 4. What a working installation looks like from the command line.

Part 7. Apply for the JetBrains Student Pack

JetBrains gives full-time students free access to its professional development tools for as long as they are enrolled. Approval is often immediate, but it can take up to a business day, so start this step before you sit down to install IntelliJ. If it is still pending on the day you install, go ahead and install anyway — the 30-day trial covers you until the license arrives.

39. Go to jetbrains.com/academy/student-pack/ and click Apply for Student Pack.
40. Choose the university email address option. It is the fastest route for us, because JetBrains recognizes our domain and verifies it in minutes. If your uark.edu address is refused for any reason, switch to the GitHub Student Developer Pack option instead.
41. Enter your uark.edu address, set your status to Student and your country to United States, accept the terms, and submit the form.
42. Open the confirmation email from JetBrains and click the link inside it.
43. Accept the license agreement, then create a JetBrains Account using that same uark.edu address, or log in if you already have one.
44. When you are finished, your JetBrains Account page shows a free educational license covering all of the JetBrains IDEs.

https://www.jetbrains.com/academy/student-pack/

Apply for a free JetBrains Student Pack

Apply with

☒ University email address

☐ ISIC / ITIC card

☐ GitHub Student Developer Pack

Email address

you@uark.edu

Status: Student Country: United States

☐ I have read and accept the terms

APPLY FOR FREE

What happens next

JetBrains emails you a confirmation link. Click it and accept the license agreement.

Create (or log into) a JetBrains Account using that same uark.edu email. Your account then shows a free educational license good for all JetBrains IDEs.

- Verifying with your uark.edu address is the fastest route — JetBrains recognizes our domain.
- Use your school address, not a personal one.
- Approval is usually minutes, but allow up to one business day. Renew each year while you are enrolled.

Illustration of the page layout — the live site may look slightly different.

Figure 5. Applying with your university email, and what JetBrains does next.

Two things to keep in mind. The student license covers coursework, personal projects, and academic research, but not commercial work for an employer. And it is renewed annually: JetBrains emails a reminder about two weeks before it lapses, and the renewal link lives in your JetBrains Account. If uark.edu is ever refused as an institution, let me know and verify through the GitHub Student Developer Pack in the meantime.

Part 8. Install IntelliJ IDEA and activate the Ultimate features

Starting with the 2025.3 release, JetBrains ships a single IntelliJ IDEA download instead of separate Community and Ultimate editions. Everyone installs the same file. The Ultimate capabilities — the professional version we want — unlock when you sign in with the student license from Part 7, so there is nothing to purchase and no trial to start.

45. Go to jetbrains.com/idea/download/ and select your operating system. On macOS, choose the Apple Silicon or the Intel build to match the processor you identified in Part 6.
46. Download and run the installer. On macOS, drag IntelliJ IDEA into your Applications folder.
47. Launch IntelliJ IDEA. When the license dialog appears, choose to log in to your JetBrains Account rather than starting a trial, sign in with your uark.edu account, and let the license activate.
48. Confirm it took: open Help and choose Register, which opens the Manage Subscriptions dialog. It should list a subscription through your educational license rather than a 30-day trial.

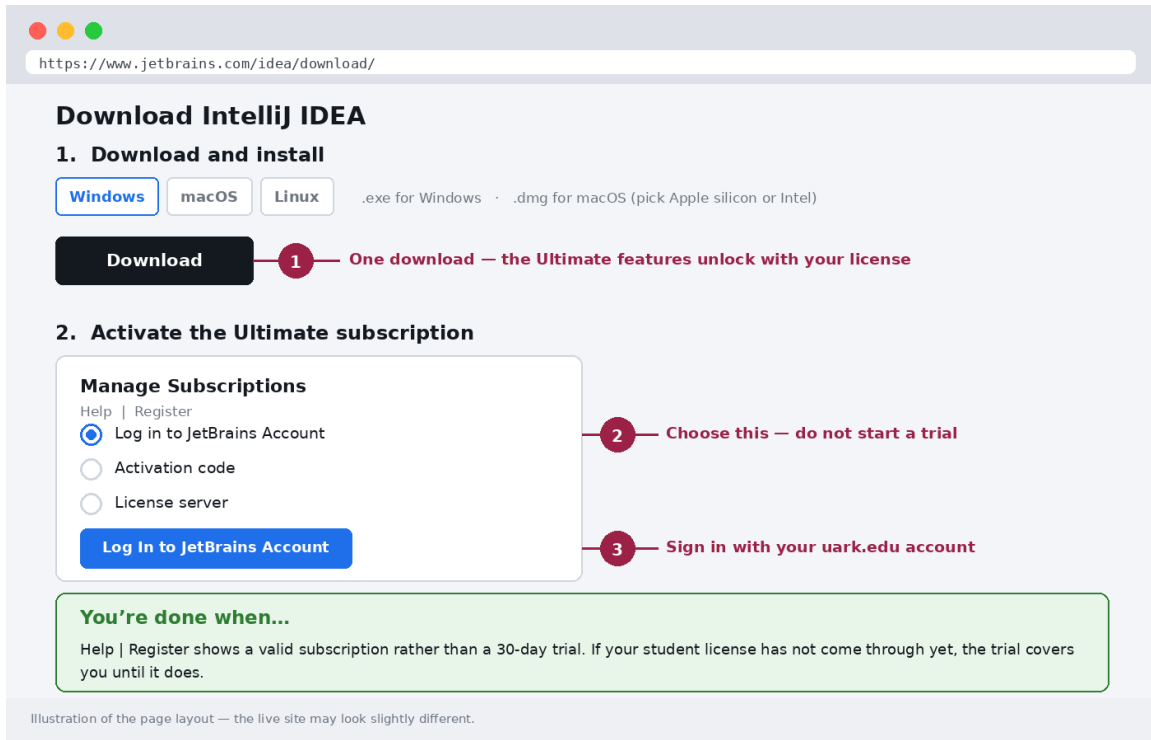


Figure 6. Download once, then activate by logging in with the account from Part 7.

If something goes wrong

If you run into this	Do this
GitHub says the username is already taken	Add a middle initial, a number, or a hyphen. The name only has to be unique on GitHub.
The GitHub verification code never arrives	Check your Junk folder, wait two minutes, then use the link on the screen to send a new code.
The download page shows no Full JDK option	Set the version, operating system, and architecture first. The Package menu refreshes for each combination.
java or javac is not recognized	Close the window and open a new one. If it still fails, run the Liberica installer again and leave the PATH and JAVA_HOME options checked.
JetBrains will not accept your uark.edu address	Verify through the GitHub Student Developer Pack instead, and Slack DM me so I can report the problem.
IntelliJ still reports a 30-day trial	Open Help, choose Register, select the option to log in to your JetBrains Account, and sign in with the address you verified in Part 7.
GitHub declines your Education application	Read the reason in the email. It is nearly always a document photo that could not be read — retake it with the whole page in frame, in good light, and reapply.

Before next class

Bring your laptop and its charger. If a step defeats you, post a description of the issue and an explanation in the #public-help Slack channel. If you are someone that has successfully completed all steps, feel free to help someone that needs it on Slack.

AI Use Disclosure

Microsoft. (2026). Microsoft Copilot [Large language model]. <https://copilot.microsoft.com>

Microsoft Copilot was used support of the creation of this guide.